

TROPHY

The Gap That Would Not Close

David Mullin's chase never quite landed a blow as Jon Baker turned healthy leads into a seventh TEG double.

Jon Baker closed out the final round at Praia D'El Rey exactly as he had led it. He took the TEG Trophy and the Green Jacket together, his seventh double, following those in TEGs 2, 4, 11, 13, 14 and 15. Neither lead changed hands in round four. Neither came close. Baker's cushion grew instead: from 11 to 18 shots in the Trophy, and from 8 to 13 in the Jacket. David Mullin played a tidy closing round and gave the field something to chase. The gap did not notice.

At the other end, Gregg Williams's tournament had been settled before he arrived, and the final round was a formality conducted at length. A quintuple-bogey 9 at the 1st established the terms of engagement early. He then rallied, in the sense that a man who has already fallen down the stairs can still walk to the kitchen, and closed with 29 points. His gap to safety widened from 8 shots to 12 by day's end. The Wooden Spoon was his, and had been for some time.

AT A GLANCE

TROPHY WINNER

Jon Baker

GREEN JACKET

Jon Baker

WOODEN SPOON

Gregg Williams

ROUND STABLEFORD

JB 40 | DM 33 | JP 33 | AB 32 | GW 29

ROUND GROSS

JB +19 | DM +24 | GW +25 | JP +35 | AB +38

AFTER R4 • TROPHY

JB 166 | DM 148 | AB 135 | JP 135 | GW 123

AFTER R4 • GREEN JACKET

JB +67 | DM +80 | GW +89 | JP +124 | AB +150

JON BAKER

Baker Grinds Out the Best Round

Two quadruple bogeys couldn't stop Jon Baker posting the best Stableford and gross scores of the final day.

Jon Baker completed the double at Praia D'El Rey, taking the 2024 TEG Trophy and the 2024 TEG Green Jacket. It is the seventh time in TEG history that one player has landed both in the same edition. He did it while posting two quadruple bogeys: a 9 at the 10th, and another 9 at the 17th, the hardest hole on the course. A lesser man

would have been embarrassed. Baker simply carried on and won everything. The same round returned the best Stableford score and the best gross score of the day, in a field spanning 40 points down to 29, and 19 over to 38 over. The card was a study in extremes. A double bogey and two early bogeys, answered by back-to-back birdies at

the 4th and the 5th. Then the wreck at the 10th, then nine points across the 14th to the 16th. His lead grew rather than shrank. The Trophy gap reached 18, the Jacket gap 13. He did not avoid the carnage. He was merely the man it charged the least.

ALEX BAKER | JOHN PATTERSON

Twin Collapses Steal the Show

While the destiny at the top was long settled, Alex Baker and John Patterson turned in a closing-day catalogue of double-figure holes.

By the time the field reached Praia D'El Rey for round 4, both the 2024 TEG Trophy and the Green Jacket were already decided, the picture unchanged from the day before. The round still produced two of the most turbulent scorecards of the tournament. Alex Baker and John Patterson played them, with nothing whatsoever at stake.

Alex began well. He picked up 9 Stableford points across three holes from the 2nd to the 4th, a man briefly in command of his own affairs. Then came the 5th, and the 5th led to the 13th. Across those nine holes he bled 25 shots, through doubles, triples and back-to-back quadruple bogeys at the 12th and 13th. From the 11th to the 13th he did not

register a single net par. It was a controlled demolition, minus the control.

Patterson's ruin arrived in discrete instalments. A sextuple bogey 10 at the 15th, one of the hardest holes on the course. A sextuple bogey 9 at the 14th, his worst hole of the tournament relative to par. Quadruple bogeys at the 1st and the 18th bookended the day with a certain tidiness.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 17, Round 4

TEG RECORDS

— Jon Baker's 2-hole "Birdies" streak ties the all-time TEG record (2), at T17 R4 H4 to T17 R4 H5

PERSONAL WORST

— John Patterson — +25 Gross on the Back nine is a personal-worst Back nine Gross

— Alex Baker's 9-hole "+2s or Worse" streak is a personal worst (previous 8), at T17 R4 H5 to T17 R4 H13

RARE FEATS

— John Patterson runs up a 9 (+6) at the 14th — his career-worst on a par-3